

COMMONERS

Commoners is an NPC supplement for 5e designed to make everyday people more useful and more memorable at the table. Rather than treating commoners as a single, interchangeable stat block, this book presents a variety of CR 0 commoners defined by their occupations—farmers, merchants, innkeepers, craftsmen, laborers, and other figures that populate towns, villages, and roads.

The intent of this product is color, texture, and low-impact utility. Each commoner is equipped with a small, profession-based ability: deliberately modest, sometimes whimsical, and always grounded in their role. These abilities are not meant to compete with adventurers or meaningfully alter combat balance. Instead, they exist to make commoners feel distinct, to reward interaction, and to give the GM light mechanical hooks for scenes involving crowds, labor, logistics, travel, or daily life.

These commoners are tools for worldbuilding rather than combat escalation. They can support social encounters, environmental problem-solving, downtime scenes, or narrative complications without drawing focus away from the player characters. Names, cultures, and personalities are intentionally undefined, allowing each stat block to represent anyone from a rural peasant to an urban tradesperson, depending on the needs of the campaign. These are ordinary people—made slightly less boring—so the world around the heroes feels lived in, functional, and real.

PROFESSIONS

Name	Description
Commoner Farmer	Tills fields, plants and harvests crops, and tends basic livestock.
Commoner Shepherd	Watches over flocks in fields and hills, skilled at keeping animals together.
Commoner Fisherman	Catches fish from rivers, lakes, or coastal waters using nets and lines.
Commoner Fishmonger	Sells fish at markets or docks, handling fresh catches daily.
Commoner Miller	Operates the local mill, grinding grain into flour for surrounding farms.
Commoner Woodcutter	Fells trees and chops firewood, working deep in forests and hills.
Commoner Charcoal Burner	Produces charcoal in forest kilns, often living far from settlements.
Commoner Beekeeper	Maintains hives for honey and wax, accustomed to calm handling of insects.
Commoner Cobbler	Repairs and crafts footwear using leather and hand tools.
Commoner Tailor	Cuts and sews garments to fit, attentive to detail and appearance.
Commoner Blacksmith	Forges tools, nails, and everyday metal goods at the anvil.
Commoner Fletcher	Crafts arrows and bolts, balancing shafts, fletching, and points.
Commoner Carpenter	Builds and repairs wooden structures, furniture, and tools.
Commoner Teamster	Handles draft animals such as oxen or horses pulling heavy loads.
Commoner Ferryman	Transports people and goods across rivers using small boats.
Commoner Sailor	Works aboard ships handling sails, rigging, and daily labor.
Commoner Ostler	Oversees travelers' mounts at inns, skilled at animal care and handling.
Commoner Innkeeper	Operates an inn providing food, drink, and lodging to travelers.
Commoner Barmaid	Serves ale and food in taverns, quick to spot trouble and hear gossip.
Commoner Cook	Prepares meals in homes, inns, or estates, accustomed to heat and knives.
Commoner Merchant	Sells goods from a fixed shop or stall, often dealing in many wares.
Commoner Trader	Buys goods in one region and sells them in another, traveling for profit.
Commoner Toll Collector	Collects fees at bridges, gates, or roads under local authority.
Commoner Rat Catcher	Hunts vermin in alleys, cellars, and sewers using traps and poisons.
Commoner Gravedigger	Digs graves and handles the dead, accustomed to grim labor.
Commoner Sexton	Maintains church buildings and graveyards, tending grounds and duties.
Commoner Busker	Performs music or simple acts in public spaces for coins.
Commoner Scribe	Reads, writes, and copies documents for townsfolk or nobles.

IMAGES

Each commoner is provided with two images: one male and one female.

COMMONER FARMER

COMMONER FARMER

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 4 (1d8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	9 (-1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Animal Handling +2, Nature +2

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Stubborn Laborer. The commoner farmer has advantage on saving throws against exhaustion caused by forced labor, marching, or harsh weather.

ACTIONS

Improvised Tool. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) bludgeoning damage.

- Rural laborers pressed into danger by circumstance or coercion.
- Low combat threat but resilient against environmental hardship.
- Useful for populating villages, caravans, and agrarian encounters.



COMMONER BLACKSMITH

COMMONER BLACKSMITH

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 5 (1d8 + 1)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	9 (-1)

Skills Athletics +3, Smith's Tools

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Forge Tempered. The commoner blacksmith has advantage on saving throws against effects caused by extreme heat or exhaustion from physical labor.

ACTIONS

Hammer. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

- Forge workers hardened by heat and repetitive labor.
- More durable than most commoners in harsh environments.
- Natural NPCs for smithies, foundries, and frontier towns.



COMMONER INNKEEPER

COMMONER INNKEEPER

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 5 (1d8 + 1)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)

Skills Insight +3, Persuasion +3

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

House Rules. While inside their own inn, the commoner innkeeper has advantage on Charisma checks made to calm disputes, negotiate terms, or refuse service.

ACTIONS

Heavy Mug. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

- Publicans and hosts who control social spaces.
- House Rules gives narrative authority in their domain.
- Useful anchors for social encounters and rumors.



COMMONER COOK

COMMONER COOK

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 4 (1d8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Survival +2, Medicine +2, Cook's utensils

Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Make Do (1/Day). When food or ingredients are scarce, the commoner cook can prepare a meal that avoids penalties from poor rations for up to six creatures for one day.

ACTIONS

Kitchen Knife. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) piercing damage.

- Camp and kitchen specialists who keep groups functional.
- Make Do prevents attrition during supply shortages.
- Valuable support NPCs in survival-focused play.



COMMONER MERCHANT

COMMONER MERCHANT

Medium humanoid (any race), any alignment

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 4 (1d8)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)

Skills Insight +3, Persuasion +3

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common

Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Appraise Goods. The commoner merchant has advantage on detecting fraudulent or forged items.

ACTIONS

Walking Stick. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) bludgeoning damage.

- Traders skilled at valuation and negotiation.
- Appraise Goods discourages scams and counterfeit plots.
- Core NPCs for markets and trade hubs.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

These commoners fit naturally into any of our [Fantasy Maps](#).

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